

GIRIDHARAN RAJENDRAN

Principal Engineer | Platform Engineering | AI Agentic Systems | DevSecOps | Cloud-Native Architecture
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Engineer and hands-on technical architect with 20 years designing cloud-native systems, AI-agentic platforms, and DevSecOps pipelines at enterprise scale. Makes independent architectural decisions, sets cross-org technical standards, writes production code. Pioneered T-Mobile's first AI-agentic developer continuous delivery platform on Anthropic's MCP — independently designed full system architecture: MCP tool-orchestration layer, RAG pipeline, REST API specifications, and zero trust security boundaries. Impact: \$1.2M+ cost savings, 5x deployments, 45% MTTR reduction, 3,100+ compliance hours saved annually.

CORE COMPETENCIES

System Architecture and Design | AI Agentic Systems | Model Context Protocol (MCP) | Generative AI (GenAI) | LLM | RAG | Cloud-Native Architecture | Platform Engineering | Developer Experience (DevEx) | SRE | DevSecOps | IaC | Distributed Systems | Microservices | Event-driven Architecture | REST API Design | Zero Trust Security | High Availability | Kubernetes | Terraform | CI/CD | GitOps | Observability | FinOps | Architecture Review Boards | Engineering Excellence | DORA Metrics | Platform as a Product | OKR-driven Execution | Stakeholder Management | Agile | SAFe

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI and Agentic: Anthropic Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude API, LLM, RAG, ChromaDB, vector databases, AI agentic systems, MCP server development, Claude Code integration

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, IAM, Lambda), Azure (AKS, ADO, Key Vault, Data Explorer), GCP; multi-cloud, cloud-native, high availability

DevSecOps and CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, CircleCI, ArgoCD, GitOps, SonarQube, SAST/DAST, policy-as-code, zero trust, SOX compliance automation

Containers and IaC: Kubernetes (EKS, AKS), Docker, Helm, Istio, Terraform, Pulumi, Ansible, Python, Golang, FastAPI, Next.js, Backstage.io

Observability and SRE: Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog, Splunk, SLI/SLO/SLA, chaos engineering, blameless postmortems, MTTR reduction

Technical Leadership: Architecture review boards, engineering standards, cross-org influence, technical mentorship, vendor management, OKR execution

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineer, (Principal-Level IC) -- Platform Engineering | T-Mobile USA | Oct 2019 - Present

- **CDP Hub -- AI-Powered Platform (Flagship Innovation Project):** Independently architected T-Mobile's official Continuous Delivery Platform (CDP) developer portal -- unified interface consolidating GitLab CI/CD tooling, platform observability, self-service automation, and organizational intelligence. Core: AI assistant

powered by Claude delivering instant answers from CDP documentation, runbooks, pipeline data, and organizational context; Jira integration for ticket creation and tracking; real-time platform monitoring. Reduced Support tickets 70%; accelerated software delivery across T-Mobile engineering teams.

- **Built CDP-MCP Server on Anthropic's Model Context Protocol (MCP)** -- enabling developers to connect via Claude Code, VSCode, or Cursor to invoke 22+ CDP tools autonomously through natural language, transforming how engineering teams interact with the platform.
- **Established technical standards, architecture review boards**, and engineering excellence across 40+ agile teams; defined multi-year cloud-native roadmap aligned with enterprise IT strategy and DORA metrics.
- Architected 100+ workload migration to Azure/Kubernetes (Terraform, GitOps) — **85% cost reduction, \$1.2M+** annual savings.
- Built GitLab CI/CD with SAST/DAST, SonarQube, policy-as-code — deployment **frequency 5x, build reliability +60%, 800+ SOX hours saved annually**.
- SOX CM.02/CM.03 Compliance Automation: Automated Change and Configuration Management controls across 22 SOX applications — **3,100+ annually, 100% audit readiness, zero findings**.
- Architected observability platform (Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog) — **MTTR -45%, outages -30% YoY, 99.9%** high availability across mission-critical systems.
- **Technical anchor for 12-member Platform Engineering team** — defined engineering standards, mentored engineers into senior roles, reduced stakeholder reporting time 75%.

Associate Manager, Software Engineering | Accenture | Sep 2010 - Oct 2019

- Directed T-Mobile Rebellion platform modernization — independently designed automation frameworks cutting **release cycles -70%**; technical standards adopted org-wide.
- Technical lead, 14-person cross-functional DevOps team — Agile/CI/CD adoption, **delivery velocity +65%**; engineering standards adopted across the organization.
- Automated 90% of manual ops; **99.9% SLA** across 52+ apps, 24x7 on-call; monitoring boosted incident response **+60%**; OKR-driven roadmaps with executive leadership.

Senior Software Engineer | Alcatel-Lucent | Oct 2009 - Sep 2010

- Designed Unix/Python automation tooling and REST API integrations; independently architected deployment pipelines reducing manual overhead 30%.

System Engineer | Wipro Technologies (Jan 2008 - Sep 2009) Junior Engineer | LASON India Pvt Ltd (May 2006 - Sep 2007)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- **T-Mobile MVP Award, Q2 2026** -- Recognized for outstanding overall platform impact and customer experience improvement.
- **University of Phoenix President's List, Jan-Jun 2026** -- Highest academic standing in MBA program while working full-time.
- **University of Phoenix Dean's List** -- Exceptional academic achievement in the MBA program.

SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- **Speaker, GitLab Commit (Global DevOps Conference):** Represented T-Mobile presenting "Build Together, Grow Together -- Inner Source Templates"; featured by GitLab (1.1M+ followers); 73 engagements, 18 comments from global DevOps community.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA), In Progress -- **President's List, Jan-Jun 2026** -- University of Phoenix (Expected 2026)

Post Graduate Program in Cloud Computing -- University of Texas at Austin (2021)

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Electronics and Communication Engineering -- Anna University, India (2005)

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

AI and ML

- Generative AI and ML Fundamentals (2025) | Agentic AI (2026) | AI Risk Management (2026) | Databricks Generative AI Fundamentals (2024)
- ML and Supervised Learning -- Skillssoft (2025) | AI Ethical Challenges and Risks -- Skillssoft (2025)

DevOps, Architecture and Leadership

- GitLab Certified Git Associate (2024) | Red Hat Certified Engineer RHCE | SRE Management (2025) | Certified Technology Architect (2012)
- SAFe 5 Product Owner and Product Manager (2022) | Leadership Development Program (2025)

MBA Badges (University of Phoenix)

- Strategic Leadership | Financial Management | Operational Efficiency